



Tool 01

The first 30 days.

A practical checklist for the early weeks after separation. Print it. Tick it. Come back to it.

This checklist helps you

- Reduce overwhelm
- Organise immediate priorities
- Protect important information
- Create practical structure
- Stop small problems becoming larger
- Keep the wheels on, this week

How to read it

Every item has a time. Start with the five things on page 01, then work down.

Today

This week

By day 30

Ongoing

In the app: [Week](#) → shows where an item lives in Atlas.

Stabilise the loud things first.

When everything feels emotionally loud, practical clarity matters. Focus on safety, money, communication, immediate routines and protecting important information.

Start here: five things today.

Today

- ☐ **1** Confirm where everyone is sleeping this week.
- ☐ **2** Reset passwords on your own email, banking and cloud accounts. For shared accounts, change access only where you're entitled to, and never log in to your ex's accounts.
- ☐ **3** Put passports, birth certificates and key documents somewhere only you can access.
- ☐ **4** Tell one trusted person what is happening. Someone who will hold it, not amplify it.
- ☐ **5** Write down the next seven days: kids, money, admin, appointments. One place, one list.

01 Safety & housing

- ☐ Make sure you have access to keys, transport and essential items. **Today**
- ☐ Pack a temporary overnight bag for the kids with essentials. **Today**
- ☐ Photograph and list major household items and shared assets, before anything moves. **This week**
[In the app: Records →](#)
- ☐ Check shared device access: Find My, location sharing, family screen time. Turn off what needs turning off. **Today**
- ☐ If you're staying in the home and it's safe to, change garage codes and security PINs. **This week**
- ☐ Confirm emergency contacts for the children at school and childcare. **This week**

Less to keep in your head.

02 Banking & money

- ☐ If you take money from a joint account for living costs, take only what you need, and record the amount, the date and the reason. Don't empty joint accounts. **Today** [In the app: Records →](#)
- ☐ Pause spending on non-essentials while the picture is still unclear. **Today**
- ☐ Download bank statements for the last 3–6 months, plus mortgage or loan statements. **This week** [In the app: Admin →](#)
- ☐ Note which credit cards are in joint names, and check access and current limits. **This week**
- ☐ Save copies of payslips and the last two years of tax returns. **By day 30** [In the app: Admin →](#)
- ☐ Sketch a rough budget: income, fixed costs, the gap. Not perfect. Just real. **By day 30** [In the app: Money →](#)
- ☐ Screenshot joint account balances and recent transactions, before anything changes. **Today**
- ☐ Open a personal bank account in your name only, if you don't already have one. **This week**
- ☐ List recurring subscriptions and direct debits. **This week** [In the app: Money →](#)
- ☐ Note bill due dates for the next 30 days. **This week** [In the app: Money →](#)
- ☐ Check superannuation balances and update your beneficiary. **By day 30**
- ☐ List every account or asset you don't yet have full clarity on. Come back later. **By day 30**

03 Legal & admin

- ☐ Start a dated log of significant conversations with your ex, written straight after each call. **Today** [In the app: Records →](#)
- ☐ Create a document folder, one per category: Financial, Kids, Legal, Property. **This week** [In the app: Admin →](#)
- ☐ Start a simple timeline: separation date, key agreements, significant events. **This week** [In the app: Records →](#)
- ☐ Save copies of property documents and title. **By day 30** [In the app: Admin →](#)
- ☐ Prepare two or three questions for your first legal or mediation appointment. **By day 30**
- ☐ Redirect important mail to your new address or a private PO box. **This week**
- ☐ List shared utilities and accounts: whose name, who's paying. **This week** [In the app: Money →](#)
- ☐ Save copies of insurance policies: home, car, health, life. **By day 30** [In the app: Admin →](#)
- ☐ Update your address and emergency contacts with Medicare, private health and other accounts. **By day 30**

Children need predictability, not perfection.

Children benefit from predictability, even when the adults are still figuring things out. The goal is not perfection. The goal is reducing unnecessary chaos.

04 Kids & school

- ☐ Confirm school drop-off and pick-up for this week.
Today [In the app: Week →](#)
- ☐ Write down the current routine in full (pickups, bedtimes, meals, activities) before it becomes disputed. This week [In the app: Records →](#)
- ☐ Duplicate essentials across both homes: chargers, toiletries, uniforms, bags, stationery. This week
- ☐ Check you can get to medications and medical information, yours and the kids', and note upcoming appointments. This week
- ☐ List important school contacts: class teacher, front office, year coordinator. By day 30
- ☐ Create a weekly kids calendar: who has the kids each night for the next four weeks.
This week [In the app: Week →](#)
- ☐ Check extracurricular and sports schedules, and sort transport for the next two weeks.
This week [In the app: Week →](#)
- ☐ Duplicate comfort items for younger children where you can. This week
- ☐ List three people who can cover childcare at short notice. This week
- ☐ Note upcoming birthdays, school events and term dates. By day 30 [In the app: Week →](#)

05 Practicals

- ☐ Restock basic groceries. Today
- ☐ Set reminders for upcoming appointments.
This week [In the app: Week →](#)
- ☐ Set up a simple weekly meal structure. Nothing elaborate, just predictable. This week
- ☐ Organise a simple laundry and school-prep rhythm for the week ahead. This week

Small stabilising actions beat dramatic reinvention.

The early weeks bring decision fatigue, mental fog and a backlog of jobs. Sleep, eat, write things down. The floor first, then the rest.

06 You & your people

- ☐ Identify who in your life feels calming rather than escalating. Stay close to them. **This week**
- ☐ Book professional support if you need it. Get the pathway open before you're in crisis. **By day 30**
- ☐ Make no major life decisions this month if you can avoid it: housing, career, relationships. **Ongoing**
- ☐ Keep basic sleep and eating routines running, and get outside each day if you can. These are the floor. **Ongoing**
- ☐ See your GP this week. Tell them what's happening. Ask about a Mental Health Treatment Plan. **This week**
- ☐ Reduce exposure to conflict-heavy conversations where you can. **Ongoing** [In the app: Scripts →](#)
- ☐ Be deliberate about alcohol. It's easy for it to become the coping plan. **Ongoing**
- ☐ Write things down rather than carrying everything in your head. That's what Atlas is for. **Ongoing** [In the app: Today →](#)

“The first month after separation is mostly an organisation problem dressed up as an emotional one.”

Atlas field note

Rough night? Someone will pick up.

If you're in danger, call 000.

1800RESPECT
1800 737 732

Lifeline
13 11 14

MensLine Australia
1300 78 99 78

Family Relationship Advice Line
1800 050 321

Kids Helpline
1800 55 1800

Enough stability for clearer decisions later.

You don't need to rebuild your whole life this month. Check in once a week: one line per area, then one thing to do.

07

Weekly check-in

What needs attention first?

	Week 1 Date ____ / ____	Week 2 Date ____ / ____	Week 3 Date ____ / ____	Week 4 Date ____ / ____
Money				
Kids				
Admin				
Housing				
Support				
One thing this week				

Closing note

Separation is not a small thing. But the first month is a solvable one.

Stability, clarity, consistency and small practical wins. You don't have to do it all at once. Atlas is there to help you move through it one week at a time.

Stability

Clarity

Consistency

Small wins



Tool 02

Financial snapshot.

Your situation is probably clearer than your nervous system thinks it is. Approximate is fine.

A clarity tool, in 20 minutes

- Cash on hand, today
- Debts in one place, and whose name they're in
- Property and assets noted
- Monthly income, all sources
- Upcoming pressure, named

Then

Ongoing costs come next, in Tool 03, the emergency budget. It starts with the monthly income you total here.

[In the app: Money](#) → keeps these numbers once you have them.

Approximate clarity beats mental chaos.

Not a legal disclosure. Not a tax worksheet. Just one clean look at where things stand, fast enough that your head can settle.

01

Cash & accounts

Available today

Account or cash source	Approximate amount
Everyday account	\$
Savings	\$
Offset account	\$
Cash on hand	\$
Shared accounts	\$
Other	\$
Total available cash	
\$	

02

Debts & liabilities

All known balances

Debt	Whose name	Approximate balance
Mortgage	☐ Mine ☐ Joint ☐ Theirs	\$
Credit cards	☐ Mine ☐ Joint ☐ Theirs	\$
Personal loans	☐ Mine ☐ Joint ☐ Theirs	\$
Car loans	☐ Mine ☐ Joint ☐ Theirs	\$
Tax debt	☐ Mine ☐ Joint ☐ Theirs	\$
Buy now, pay later	☐ Mine ☐ Joint ☐ Theirs	\$
Other	☐ Mine ☐ Joint ☐ Theirs	\$
Total debt		\$

What you own and what's coming.

03

Property & assets

Estimates are fine

Asset	Whose name			Estimated value
Home	☐ Mine	☐ Joint	☐ Theirs	\$
Investment property	☐ Mine	☐ Joint	☐ Theirs	\$
Vehicles	☐ Mine	☐ Joint	☐ Theirs	\$
Shares and investments	☐ Mine	☐ Joint	☐ Theirs	\$
Superannuation	☐ Mine	☐ Joint	☐ Theirs	\$
Other	☐ Mine	☐ Joint	☐ Theirs	\$

Estimated asset total

\$

04

Monthly income

Income source	Monthly
Salary / wages	\$
Child support received	\$
Centrelink / Family Tax Benefit	\$
Freelance / side income	\$
Rental income	\$
Other	\$

Monthly income

\$

Carry this to Tool 03, page 01.

05

What's coming

Tick what's live

- ☐ Upcoming legal costs.
- ☐ Housing uncertainty.
- ☐ School fees.
- ☐ Vehicle expenses: rego, service, repairs.
- ☐ Tax obligations.
- ☐ Reduced income risk.
- ☐ Debt repayment pressure.
- ☐ Medical costs.
- ☐ Shared asset uncertainty.
- ☐ Childcare cost changes.

Right now, what feels financially unclear, and what's the next practical thing to organise?



Tool 03

Emergency budget.

Get the numbers quiet enough to think. A practical reset for the first weeks after separation.

This worksheet helps you

- Understand your real monthly position
- Take pressure off spending
- Name immediate financial risks
- See a bare-minimum survival number
- Check your housing pressure
- Plan a small, realistic buffer

Before you start

Do Tool 02 first. You'll carry your monthly income from there.

You finish with four numbers to keep. [In the app: Money →](#)

What does survival actually cost?

Separation creates financial fog. The goal here isn't perfection or optimisation. It's one clean look at the real monthly position. Approximate is fine.

01

Monthly income

Carry from Tool 02

Monthly income (from Tool 02)

\$

02

Essential expenses

Essential expense	Monthly
Rent / mortgage	\$
Utilities	\$
Groceries	\$
Fuel / transport	\$
Insurance	\$
Phone / internet	\$
Child expenses	\$
Child support paid	\$
School costs	\$
Medical & medication	\$
Debt repayments	\$
Other essentials	\$

Essential monthly cost

\$

Pressure off, not punishment on.

Some expenses are survival. Some are comfort. Some are future problems dressed up as current necessities. Pausing is temporary. Sort each row, then move on.

03

Optional & pausable expenses

Sort each row

Expense	Keep	Pause	Reduce	\$ / month saved
Streaming services	☐	☐	☐	\$
Gym & memberships	☐	☐	☐	\$
Dining out	☐	☐	☐	\$
App & software subscriptions	☐	☐	☐	\$
Shopping & clothing	☐	☐	☐	\$
Alcohol	☐	☐	☐	\$
Kids extras & activities	☐	☐	☐	\$
Holidays & travel	☐	☐	☐	\$
Entertainment	☐	☐	☐	\$
Other	☐	☐	☐	\$

Saved each month

\$

04

Immediate financial risks

Tick what's live

- ☐ Upcoming large bills in the next 30 days.
- ☐ Housing instability or short notice period.
- ☐ Tax uncertainty: return, BAS or debt.
- ☐ Reduced or uncertain income.
- ☐ Vehicle costs: rego, service, repairs.
- ☐ Shared debt with unclear obligation.
- ☐ Credit card balance creeping up.
- ☐ Legal costs without a clear ceiling.
- ☐ Childcare costs likely to change.
- ☐ Insurance gap: health, car, contents.

If things got tight, what do you need?

This number brings realism, a fallback and calmer decisions. You're not living here. You're knowing where the floor is.

05

Survival budget, essentials only

Floor, not lifestyle

Category	Minimum monthly cost
Housing	\$
Food	\$
Utilities	\$
Transport	\$
Children	\$
Child support paid	\$
Insurance	\$
Medical	\$
Debt minimums	\$
Phone / internet	\$
Other essentials	\$

Survival number, per month

\$

If income dropped suddenly, what would matter most, and what would you protect first?

Sustainability, not optimisation.

Once the immediate pressure eases, the goal is a month that doesn't quietly take more than it gives. Then check the biggest single source of pressure: housing.

06 Stabilised budget

Category	Monthly
Essential monthly cost (page 01)	\$
Kids activities	\$
Savings buffer	\$
Social & connection	\$
Health & fitness	\$
Household maintenance	\$
Clothing	\$
Small enjoyment budget	\$

Stabilised monthly number

\$

07 Buffer target

Buffer level	Target
One week of essentials = essential monthly cost ÷ 4	\$
One month of essentials = essential monthly cost × 1	\$
Three months of essentials = essential monthly cost × 3	\$

What's the first realistic buffer target?

08 Housing pressure

Use take-home pay

Monthly housing costs

\$

Monthly take-home pay

\$

Housing % of take-home pay

%

= housing ÷ take-home pay × 100

Under 30%

Manageable

Generally workable. Keep the buffer growing and check again each year.

30–45%

Active

Needs active budgeting. Watch the pausable list closely.

Over 45%

Pressure

Ongoing pressure and less room to move. Consider a structural change.

See it clearly enough to stop catastrophising.

Carry these four numbers forward. Redo them in a month. Most of the panic comes from not knowing, and now you know.

09 Your numbers, right now

Carry these four numbers

Survival number · page 03

\$

Stabilised monthly number · page 04

\$

Housing % of take-home pay · page 04

%

First buffer target · page 04

\$

[In the app: Money →](#)

What's the biggest financial pressure right now?

What's the next practical financial step?

Closing note

Visible numbers reduce fear.

Financial clarity doesn't solve everything. But uncertainty uses up a lot of energy. Small systems reduce panic, and progress often starts with seeing the situation clearly enough to stop catastrophising it.

Clarity

Visibility

Breathing room

Steadier decisions